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Pennsylvania
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April 16, 2013

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Dr. Vincent Troia, Executive Chairman
Ohio River Trail Council
1519 Staunton Drive
Moon Township, PA 15108

Re: ORTC Request for Funding – Ohio River South Shore Trail, Phase I

Dear Dr. Troia;

I am pleased to provide this letter of support from the Southwestern Pennsylvania Commission (SPC) for a 2013 DCNR Recreational Trails Program grant application for the above referenced project.

This project will result in the preparation of engineering specifications and bid documents for the construction of the 3.5 mile ORSST-Phase I project, and create connection for pedestrians and cyclists between Allegheny County's Sports Legacy Park at Montour Junction and the communities of Sewickley and Leetsdale, via the Sewickley Bridge. In so doing it will provide connections from the Montour Trail to the communities of Coraopolis, Moon Township and Sewickley, including two new trailhead facilities in those communities.

This project will also bring opportunities for trail related economic benefits to these communities while making opportunities for active transportation more readily accessible to residents of our region.

This project is consistent with the policy statements of the 2040 Transportation and Development Plan for Southwestern Pennsylvania that call for the provision of multimodal transportation options, and call for the connection of existing regional trail assets to additional communities through the establishment of expanded trail networks.

As such, we support the above referenced application for funding from the Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources' Recreational Trails program.

Sincerely,

James R. Hassinger, Ph.D., AICP
Executive Director

Cc: Lauren Imgrund, PA DCNR

Two Chatham Center
Suite 500
112 Washington Place
Pittsburgh, PA 15219-3451
Telephone: 412.391.5590
Fax: 412.391.9160
E-Mail: comments@spcregion.org
www.spcregion.org